

Home safety guide with fall prevention checklists, emergency response plans, and assistive device recommendations for aging-in-place families — Action Checklist

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ASSESS BATHROOM TRANSFER RISKS

- ☐ **Assess Bathroom Transfer Risks:** Watch your parent perform the three daily bathroom transfers—getting on and off the toilet, entering the shower, and standing after bathing—to identify which specific movements are highest risk.
- ☐ **Assess Bathroom Transfer Risks:** Identify every surface your parent uses to push off when standing, such as sinks, counters, or towel bars, and note that these surfaces are not designed to support body weight and are fall liabilities.
- ☐ **Assess Bathroom Transfer Risks:** Determine whether your parent steps over a tub wall to enter the shower, which creates a dangerous combination of wet feet, wet tub surface, and holding onto a glass door or curtain.
- ☐ **Assess Bathroom Transfer Risks:** Check if there is a nightstand, table, or other surface next to the toilet that your parent uses for support when sitting down or standing up, since proper grab bars are a better solution.

INSTALL GRAB BARS CORRECTLY

- ☐ **Install Grab Bars Correctly:** Mount a horizontal grab bar on the wall behind the toilet to give your parent something solid to grip while lowering onto the seat or pushing up from the seat.
- ☐ **Install Grab Bars Correctly:** Install a grab bar inside the shower on the wall your parent faces when standing under the water spray, which is the most natural hand position during bathing.
- ☐ **Install Grab Bars Correctly:** Mount a vertical grab bar on the outside of the shower entrance where your parent steps over the threshold, because this is where most people lose their balance during entry and exit.
- ☐ **Install Grab Bars Correctly:** Replace all bathroom towel bars with grab bars rated for 250 to 500 pounds that are properly mounted with screws driven directly into wall studs for secure support.

DOCUMENT & FOLLOW THROUGH

- ☐ **Document & Follow Through:** Create a written safety score for each room in your parent's home based on your audit findings, listing specific risks and whether they are minor, moderate, or severe.
 - ☐ **Document & Follow Through:** Sort all identified risks into a 30-day action plan, starting with grab bar installation and throw rug removal, then moving to lighting and furniture arrangement improvements.
 - ☐ **Document & Follow Through:** Establish a written emergency response protocol your parent can follow if a fall occurs while you are not present, including how to call for help and what to do while waiting.
 - ☐ **Document & Follow Through:** Schedule a follow-up reassessment in 60 to 90 days to verify that modifications are being used properly and to identify any new fall risks that have emerged over time.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.